

YouTube LIVE!

Live video has finally come to YouTube via a CBS video. The irony? The video is powered by Microsoft's Silverlight

The Cloud

Simply put, "The Cloud" is analogous to the internet, not to be confused with "cloud computing" or "grid computing"

CONNECTIONS

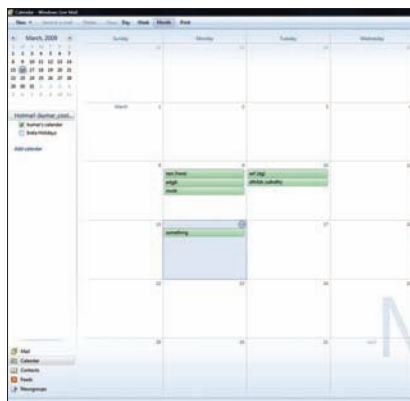
password. Next you can either add your contacts to the Personal Address book of Thunderbird or select the option for a separate Zindus address book so as to keep your contacts in a separate book.

Once that is done, click on OK and your contacts will be in synch from now on.

Synching with Windows Live Mail

Synching your Calendar with a web service is of great importance. Windows Live Calendar is a service provided by Windows Live where you can keep track of all your appointments and events; especially useful to those who travel a lot and access their accounts through different means. Sure, there is the option of using Microsoft Outlook, but this does not give a proper synch between the Calendar and the Windows Live calendar. If you want an email client which is very similar to Outlook, then we suggest you use Windows Live Mail.

Windows Live Mail is an application created by Windows Live that lets you have your Live Calendar on your desk-



Windows Live Mail Calendar in synch

top along with your email accounts, all synched into a single program. You need to first download Windows Live Mail from <http://download.live.com/>. Once you have setup your account with Live Mail, you will notice the design similarities between this and Microsoft Outlook, but even so, it offers you a more sophisticated, but at the same time, a simple appeal.

Now you can make changes to your Windows Live Mail client through the Calendar feature, which will then be updated on Windows Live Calendar, and vice versa. Having your calendar in synch with a web service will keep you and your work in harmony.

Synching with Plaxo

Plaxo is a great service to keep all your contacts and calendars in synch. Plaxo is a web-based application which stores your contacts and calendars on its servers so that all your data is secure in case your computer crashes. It syncs calendar data from multiple service providers such as

Google, Yahoo! and Microsoft Outlook.

To start off, first go to www.plaxo.com and sign up with a free account. There is also a premium version of Plaxo that you can opt for. After you have registered and activated your account, you start off with the service. Now Plaxo is not only a syncing service but it doubles as a sort of social networking site where you can add friends, videos and photos. But you can ignore that part of the service and use it solely for your contacts and calendar.

Once you login, you have the following options: Plaxo, MyProfile, Connections and More. Under More you can select your address book. Here is where you can sync all your contacts. We synched Yahoo! and Gmail contacts. Now on selecting any contact you also have the option to send that contact an email, and you can also select which service you want to use — either Gmail or Yahoo! to send that particular mail.

In Outlook Express, you can synch your contacts from multiple accounts such as Yahoo!, Gmail and MSN, that you have setup on the Plaxo web site. These contacts can either be added to a common address book or can be added to separate address books as per the service. The Plaxo toolbar on Outlook Express gives you quick access to sync and also gives you options to check your online calendar on Plaxo.

To synch your calendar, you will find the Calendar option under More. Here you will have to create Sync Points where you can synch your Yahoo!, MSN and Google calendars together. A current drawback with Plaxo is that it only supports single direction calendar synch with Google. So any changes made on Plaxo will be shown on Google Calendar, but not vice-versa.

Plaxo also supports synching contacts with Windows Mobile, but this service comes only with Plaxo Premium. If you want to test drive the same, there is a 30-day trial available.

Synching with MobileMe

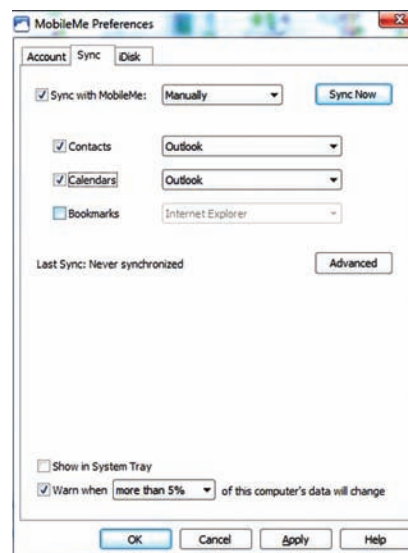
MobileMe is an online application that has been created by Apple and is used to synch contacts, calendars and bookmarks, and even emails, between the iPhone or iPod Touch and a PC or a Mac. MobileMe is a commercial application, but you can use the 30-day free trial to check it out first at www.me.com.

Before synching your data with MobileMe, you will need to backup your existing contacts, calendars and bookmarks, as MobileMe overwrites the existing ones. To do so, first connect your device to the PC and start iTunes. Go to the Info Tab and select Outlook to synch your contacts, calendars and bookmarks to it. Click Apply and then Sync. After the synch is complete you might want to double-check to see if the data is now on the PC. To do this, just open the application you chose, Outlook in our case, and check the contents.

Once that's done, we will now need to

synch this data with MobileMe. For this, you will need to download the MobileMe Control Panel which is a small application that will keep your device in synch at all times. You can download this from: http://support.apple.com/downloads/MobileMe_Control_Panel_for_Windows.

After downloading and installing, you can start the application which is called the Control Panel. Enter your MobileMe account details and then go to the Sync tab. Check the 'Sync with MobileMe' checkbox and then select the intervals at which you want to synch. You can choose for this process to be manual or automatic; and hourly, daily or weekly. Next select the checkboxes for contacts, calendars and bookmarks and select the application that was specified in iTunes. In our case it was Outlook. Click the Synch Now button. After doing that again, it would be wise to just check and see if your data has been moved to MobileMe. For that you can



Import your calendar and contacts

login at www.me.com and check just to be on the safe side.

Last, you will need to setup MobileMe on the iPhone or iPod Touch. For this just tap to Settings > Mail, Contacts, Calendars > Add Account on your Apple device. Here, select MobileMe and enter your account details and tap on Save. Next, choose the data that you want to be synched and tap on Save. Remember when you tap the Sync button, MobileMe will overwrite your existing data. To avoid this, follow the steps mentioned above.

If you have followed all the steps here, you are now living within the cloud, thanks to having your data online. With these steps you can now make changes to your calendar or add a new contact even when you are on the go and when you are back at your work laptop or on your home PC, the changes that you have made will all be in synch. ■

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